

Customer Success: SLA & Crisis Escalation Matrix

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Department: Customer Success / Legal

Classification: Internal / All Staff

Type: Policy Document

1. Service Level Agreements (SLA)

We categorize customer support requests based on the impact on their business operations. Agents must prioritize tickets according to these response windows:

Priority	Definition	Initial Response	Resolution Target
P0 - Urgent	System is down; revenue-impacting.	< 1 Hour	4 Hours
P1 - High	Major feature broken; no workaround.	< 4 Hours	8 Hours
P2 - Normal	Minor bug; workaround exists.	< 24 Hours	3 Business Days
P3 - Low	General questions; feature requests.	< 48 Hours	5 Business Days

2. Crisis Definitions

A "Crisis" is an event that bypasses standard support queues and requires immediate intervention from Senior Management or the Engineering Lead.

2.1 Technical Crisis

- **Data Breach:** Any report of unauthorized data access (Trigger **Data Security Protocol**).
- **Extended Outage:** A SEV-1 incident lasting more than 60 minutes without a clear path to resolution.

- **Mass Corruption:** Reports of data being lost or overwritten across multiple customer accounts.

2.2 Commercial & Legal Crisis

- **Legal Threat:** Any written or verbal threat of litigation or "calling a lawyer."
- **PR/Social Media Blowout:** A negative post about the company that has gained >1,000 interactions.
- **Abusive Behavior:** A customer using hate speech, threats of violence, or persistent harassment toward a support agent.

3. Escalation Workflow (Order of Operations)

When a Crisis is identified by a Support Agent or the AI Assistant:

1. **Immediate Internal Alert:** Ping the @support-leadership alias in Slack.
2. **Tagging:** Apply the [CRISIS] tag to the ticket in the CRM.
3. **Human Handover:** If the user is currently in a chat session, the agent must use the following script: "I've flagged this for our senior leadership team for immediate review. A manager will take over this conversation directly within the next 15 minutes."
4. **Information Gathering:** While waiting for the manager, the agent should gather all relevant "Correlation IDs" and logs from the **Troubleshooting Matrix**.

4. On-Call Management Escalation

If an agent cannot reach their direct supervisor during a P0/Crisis event:

- **Primary:** CS Manager (on-call).
- **Secondary:** Director of Customer Success.
- **Tertiary:** Chief Operating Officer (COO).

5. Violation of SLA

If a P0 or P1 ticket misses its "Initial Response" window:

- An automated alert is sent to the CEO.
- A "Missed SLA" report is generated for the monthly Board of Directors meeting.

Note to AI Assistant:

This is your most important instruction for "Escalation" logic:

1. **Identify Crisis Keywords:** If the user mentions "lawyer," "suing," "data leak," "hacked," or uses "profanity/abusive language," you must immediately trigger the **Human Intervention** protocol.
2. **SLA Calculation:** If a user asks "When will my ticket be fixed?", identify their priority level (P0-P3) and provide the "Resolution Target" from the table in Section 1.
3. **Handoff:** Do not attempt to solve "Crisis" level issues. Follow the handover script in

Section 3, Step 3.